

Strengths

One of my strengths in my storytelling speech was that I maintained eye contact (85, 8th Edition) with the audience, which helped me connect with my audience during my speech. I had a tendency to stay looking at one side of the room, but I was looking at the audience nevertheless. I was able to not appear confident and focus on how I portray myself.

Another strength was my natural flow (Prof B) in my speech. I had an organized introduction, short story, and conclusion with what I learned from the experience. I believe that it was easy to follow, which made the story more memorable.

Finally, I liked my topic and how I was able to speak about it properly because it was something that I am interested in (Prof B). This allowed me to put more effort into perfecting my tone and actions during the speech.

Weaknesses

One weakness was that I practiced too much before presenting, which made my delivery sound memorized (91, 8th Edition) rather than spoken. Over-practicing limited my ability to adapt on the fly in the moment

Another weakness was that in the first half of my speech, I looked down at my note card (Prof B) for too long and too many times, which once again took away from my delivery.

Finally, I struggled with the flexibility (14, 8th Edition) of my speech. Since I had memorized my speech, it may have sounded slightly robotic rather than a cohesive story about my experiences.

How To Improve:

To improve the amount that I practice, I should take breaks between my rehearsals and focus less on memorization and more on learning the material (99, 8th Edition).

To improve my note card dependence, I can once again practice and focus on the research portion (54, 8th Edition) of the project that will be reflected in the speech.

For my flexibility, I should practice my delivery techniques so that I can adapt fluently whenever I do mess up during my speech. This will also strengthen my confidence and credibility (78, 8th Edition).